



★ THE BIG VOLUME • 5 PARTS ★

THE ROYAL COOKBOOK

79 recipes from the castle kitchen

BY CHEF PETER

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★
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★ PART ONE ★



THE ROYAL MENU

Foundations & the 14 castle classics

★ ★ ★



ROYAL SAUCE

The secret of the kingdom



FREE

BUILDING BLOCK

3 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 tbsp mayonnaise
- ◆ ½ tbsp ketchup
- ◆ ¼ tbsp pickle relish
- ◆ (or finely chopped pickles)
- ◆ Pinch of smoked paprika
- ◆ Tiny pinch of salt

- 1 Put all the ingredients in a small bowl.
- 2 Stir with a spoon until smooth and one color.
- 3 Taste! Add more ketchup if you want it sweeter, more paprika for smokier.
- 4 Cover and keep in the fridge until you need it. Lasts 3 days.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Make a triple batch and keep it in a jar. You'll use it on burgers, nuggets, fries, sandwiches — everything.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** a few drops of sriracha.
Garlicky: grate in a tiny bit of garlic.
Smoky BBQ: swap the relish for BBQ sauce.

GLUTEN-FREE Royal Sauce is **naturally gluten-free**. Just double-check the ketchup label — some brands sneak in barley malt.



ROYAL BREADCRUMBS

The crispy coating



FREE

BUILDING BLOCK

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 thick slice wholemeal bread
- ◆ ½ clove of garlic, peeled
- ◆ ¼ tsp salt
- ◆ Pinch of black pepper

- 1 Tear the bread into chunks. Put them in a food processor.
- 2 Add the garlic, salt, and pepper.
- 3 Blitz on high until you have fine crumbs.
- 4 Tip onto a plate. Ready to coat chicken or fish.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Stale bread blitzes finer than fresh. Save the heels of old loaves in a bag in the freezer for this.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Italian style:** add a pinch of dried oregano. **Extra crunch:** use panko instead. **Smoky:** add ¼ tsp smoked paprika.

GLUTEN-FREE Use 1 slice of **gluten-free bread** instead of wholemeal. Same blitzing technique. (Stale GF bread works even better.)



CASTLE CLASSIC

Beef burger · cheddar · pickles · royal sauce



4

COINS

12 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 150g beef mince
- ♦ 1 brioche bun
- ♦ 1 slice cheddar
- ♦ A few pickle slices
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ 1 tsp oil
- ♦ Royal Sauce (recipe #0)

- 1 Make the royal sauce if you haven't already.
- 2 Form the mince into one ball, then press into a flat patty slightly bigger than the bun (it shrinks).
- 3 Sprinkle salt and pepper on both sides. Press your thumb into the middle — this stops it from puffing up.
- 4 Heat the oil in a small pan on medium-high. Lay the patty in.
- 5 Cook 3 minutes per side. **Don't press it down** — that squeezes the juices out.
- 6 In the last minute, lay the cheese on top. Cover the pan with a lid for 30 seconds so the cheese melts.
- 7 Toast the bun in the same pan for 30 seconds — it soaks up the beef flavor.
- 8 Build: bottom bun → sauce → patty → pickles → sauce on top bun.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ The thumb dimple in the middle is the chef secret — without it the patty puffs into a meatball.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Bacon Castle:** add 2 strips of crispy bacon. **BBQ:** swap royal sauce for BBQ sauce. **Mushroom:** add fried mushrooms.

GLUTEN-FREE Swap the brioche bun for a **gluten-free bun**. Toast it in butter — they crisp up beautifully.

2

DOUBLE KNIGHT

Two patties · double cheese · bacon armor

1

SERVES

6

COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 150g beef mince
- ♦ 1 brioche bun
- ♦ 2 slices cheddar
- ♦ 2 strips streaky bacon
- ♦ A few pickle slices
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ Royal sauce (recipe #0)

- 1 Make the royal sauce.
- 2 Form 2 thin patties (about 75g each). Sprinkle salt and pepper on both sides.
- 3 Cook the bacon in a dry pan until crispy. Move to kitchen paper. **Keep the bacon fat in the pan** – that's flavor gold.
- 4 Cook the patties in the bacon fat for 2 minutes per side. Add a slice of cheese on each in the last 30 seconds.
- 5 Toast the bun in the pan.
- 6 Build: bottom bun → sauce → patty → bacon → second patty → pickles → top bun.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Two thin patties beat one thick patty – more crispy edges, more flavor. This is how diners do smash burgers.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Triple Knight:** add a third patty. **Spicy:** swap one cheese for pepper jack. **Egg armor:** add a fried egg on top.

GLUTEN-FREE Swap the brioche bun for a **gluten-free bun**. Bacon, beef, and cheese are all naturally GF.

4

COINS

20 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 chicken breast (about 120g)

THE COATING

- ◆ 2 tbsp flour
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ ¼ tsp pepper
- ◆ ¼ tsp smoked paprika (color & flavor)
- ◆ 1 small egg, beaten
- ◆ Royal Breadcrumbs (recipe #0a)
- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil

TO BUILD

- ◆ 1 brioche bun
- ◆ 1 slice cheddar
- ◆ A few pickle slices
- ◆ Royal Sauce (recipe #0)

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 Put the chicken between two sheets of baking paper. Bash with a rolling pin to about 1cm thick — this makes it cook evenly.
- 3 Set up 3 plates: seasoned flour · beaten egg · breadcrumbs.
- 4 Coat: **flour first** (shake off extra), then **egg** (let drip), then **press into breadcrumbs** from all sides.
- 5 Heat oil in an oven-safe pan on medium. Fry the chicken 3 minutes per side until golden.
- 6 Lay the cheese on top and put the whole pan in the oven for 1 minute to melt.
- 7 Toast the bun. Build: bottom bun → sauce → crispy chicken → pickles → sauce on top bun.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ The 3-dip method (flour, egg, crumbs) makes the coating stick and stay crispy. Patchy coating = sad sandwich.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** cayenne in the breadcrumbs. **Buttermilk Queen:** soak chicken in buttermilk 1 hour first. **BBQ:** BBQ sauce instead of royal.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF flour** AND **GF royal breadcrumbs** (recipe #0a, GF version). Plus a GF bun.



LITTLE PRINCE

Smaller burger for young royals



COINS 10 MIN EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 100g beef mince
- ♦ 1 small bun (slider bun)
- ♦ 1 slice mild cheese
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ 1 tsp oil
- ♦ Ketchup or royal sauce

- 1 Form 1 small patty (about 100g). Tiny pinch of salt and pepper.
- 2 Heat oil in a pan on medium. Cook 2½ minutes per side.
- 3 In the last 30 seconds, lay the cheese on top. Cover so it melts.
- 4 Toast the small bun.
- 5 Build: bottom bun → sauce → small patty → top bun.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Skip the pickles and onions for picky eaters — kids can smell anything green from a mile away.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Plain Jane:** just patty and ketchup.
Cheesy: add a second slice of cheese.
Star: use a star cookie cutter to make star-shaped patties.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **small gluten-free bun** instead of regular. Patty itself is GF.

3

COINS

35 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 4 large potatoes (Maris Piper or Russet)
- ♦ 1 litre vegetable oil, for deep frying
- ♦ ½ tsp smoked salt
- ♦ Black pepper

- 1 Cut potatoes into 1cm-thick chips (skin on if you like).
- 2 Cut potatoes into 1cm-thick chips. **Soak in cold water 20 min** – this washes off starch and makes them crispy. Drain and dry VERY well (wet chips spit in the oil).
- 3 **First fry:** a grown-up heats the oil to 150°C. Fry the chips in small batches 5 min until soft but still pale. Lift onto kitchen paper to cool.
- 4 **Second fry:** turn the oil up to 190°C. Fry the chips again in batches 2–3 min until deep golden and crispy.
- 5 Drain on kitchen paper and toss with smoked salt and pepper while hot.
- 6 Eat fast. Crispy chips wait for no one.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Fry TWICE – once gentle to cook through, once hot to crisp. That is the chip-shop secret. A grown-up always handles the hot oil.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Garlic Parmesan:** toss in grated parmesan and parsley after frying.
Spicy: add cayenne to the salt.
Truffle: drizzle truffle oil after.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF! No swaps needed.

6

CROWN NUGGETS

Crispy homemade chicken nuggets

1

SERVES

4

COINS

35 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 400g chicken mince (or 2 chicken breasts, blitzed)
- ♦ 1 tsp salt
- ♦ ½ tsp pepper
- ♦ ½ tsp garlic powder
- ♦ ½ tsp onion powder
- ♦ 2 tbsp flour
- ♦ 1 egg, beaten
- ♦ Royal Breadcrumbs (recipe #0a)
- ♦ 1 litre vegetable oil, for deep frying
- ♦ Royal Sauce or ketchup to dip

- 1 Mix the chicken mince with salt, pepper, garlic powder, onion powder and 1 tbsp of the flour until sticky.
- 2 Wet your hands and shape into nugget shapes (about 1 tbsp each). Chill 15 min so they hold their shape.
- 3 Set up 3 plates: remaining flour · egg · breadcrumbs.
- 4 Coat each nugget: flour → egg → breadcrumbs. Press the crumbs in firmly.
- 5 A grown-up heats the oil to 175°C. Fry the nuggets in small batches 4–5 min until deep golden and cooked through.
- 6 Drain on kitchen paper. Serve with royal sauce or ketchup.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Real nuggets are made from minced chicken, not slabs — shaping by hand is what gives them that proper nugget bite. Chill before frying so they keep their shape.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** cayenne in the flour. **Cheesy:** mix grated parmesan into the crumbs. **Tendies:** shape into strips instead of nuggets.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF flour** and **GF Royal Breadcrumbs**.



MOAT MOZZA STICKS

Crispy mozzarella sticks · marinara dip



3

COINS

30 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 1 block mozzarella (about 200g) — the firm kind, not fresh
- ♦ 2 tbsp flour
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ ¼ tsp Italian herbs
- ♦ 1 egg, beaten
- ♦ Royal Breadcrumbs (recipe #0a) + 2 tbsp grated parmesan
- ♦ 3 tbsp oil for frying
- ♦ 4 tbsp tomato passata + pinch garlic powder + pinch sugar (for dip)

- 1 Cut the mozzarella into finger-thick sticks (8 sticks).
- 2 **Freeze 20 minutes** — this is THE secret. Cold cheese doesn't leak in the pan.
- 3 Set up 3 plates: seasoned flour · egg · breadcrumbs mixed with parmesan.
- 4 Coat each stick: flour → egg → crumbs → **egg again** → **crumbs again** (double coat).
- 5 Back in the freezer for another 10 minutes.
- 6 Heat oil in a pan on medium-high. Fry sticks 60 seconds per side until golden — work fast!
- 7 Warm the passata with garlic powder and sugar for the dip.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Freezing + double-coating is what stops the cheese exploding. Skip either and you get a cheese puddle.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** chilli flakes in the crumbs.
Garlic: garlic powder in the flour.
Pizza Sticks: dip in pizza sauce.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF flour** and **GF Royal Breadcrumbs**. Mozzarella is naturally GF.

ONION RINGS OF POWER

Crispy battered onion rings

3

COINS

20 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 large onions
- ♦ 100g flour
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ ¼ tsp smoked paprika
- ♦ ¼ tsp baking powder (for puff!)
- ♦ 150ml cold sparkling water
- ♦ 3 tbsp oil for frying
- ♦ Royal Sauce or BBQ to dip

- 1 Cut the onions into 1cm thick rings. Separate them.
- 2 Mix flour, salt, paprika, and baking powder in a bowl.
- 3 Whisk in the **cold** sparkling water — keep it cold and fizzy, the bubbles make the batter light.
- 4 Dip each ring in batter. Let extra drip off.
- 5 Heat oil in a pan on medium-high. Fry rings 1½ min per side until golden.
- 6 Drain on kitchen paper. Sprinkle salt. Serve with dip.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Cold + bubbles = crispy batter. Use the water straight from the fridge, mix at the last minute.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** cayenne in the batter. **Beer-battered:** swap water for cold beer (grown-ups). **Sweet:** sprinkle sugar instead of salt.

GLUTEN-FREE Swap flour for **GF flour** + 1 extra tsp baking powder. Same crispy result.

9

LOADED CASTLE FRIES

Fries with cheese, bacon & spring onion

1

SERVES

5

COINS

35 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ Drawbridge Fries (recipe #5)
- ◆ 100g grated cheddar
- ◆ 4 strips bacon, cooked & chopped
- ◆ 2 spring onions, sliced
- ◆ Sour cream or royal sauce
- ◆ Pinch of paprika

- 1 Make the Drawbridge Fries (recipe #5).
- 2 When they're crispy, leave them on the tray.
- 3 Scatter the cheese all over.
- 4 Pop back in the oven for 3 minutes until cheese is melted and bubbly.
- 5 Top with bacon, spring onion, paprika, and dollops of sour cream.
- 6 Serve straight from the tray — eat with forks.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Don't pile the toppings on COLD fries. The cheese needs to melt over hot fries, or it goes plasticky.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **BBQ:** drizzle BBQ sauce. **Veggie:** skip bacon, add black beans and corn.
Loaded Royals: add chopped jalapeños.

GLUTEN-FREE Fries, bacon, cheese, and sour cream are all naturally GF. Easy.



DRAGON'S BREATH

Thick chocolate shake · whipped cream



COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 4 scoops chocolate ice cream
- ♦ 60ml whole milk
- ♦ 1 tbsp cocoa powder
- ♦ Tiny pinch of salt
- ♦ Whipped cream
- ♦ Chocolate sauce
- ♦ Chocolate flake or sprinkles

- 1 Put ice cream, milk, cocoa, and salt in a blender. **Less milk than you think** — this is a thick shake, not a thin drink.
- 2 Blitz on low first, then high, for about 30 seconds — until thick but still smooth.
- 3 It should be so thick the spoon stands up. If it's too thick, add 1 tbsp more milk.
- 4 Pour into a tall glass. Top with whipped cream, drizzle chocolate sauce, crumble a flake on top.
- 5 Stick in a straw AND a long spoon. Serve immediately.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ The tiny pinch of salt is a chef trick — it makes chocolate taste MORE chocolatey. Don't skip it.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Cookies & Cream:** blend in 3 crumbled Oreos. **Mint Dragon:** add 2 drops peppermint extract. **Peanut Butter:** blend in 1 tbsp peanut butter.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF chocolate sauce** and check the ice cream label. Most are GF naturally.

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 lemons (juice = about 80ml)
- ♦ 3 tbsp sugar
- ♦ 3 tbsp hot water
- ♦ 400ml cold sparkling water
- ♦ 6 strawberries, halved
- ♦ A few mint leaves
- ♦ Ice cubes

- 1 Stir sugar with HOT water in a glass until fully dissolved — this is your syrup (cold water won't dissolve sugar).
- 2 Squeeze lemons. Stir juice into the syrup.
- 3 In two tall glasses, drop strawberries, mint leaves, and ice.
- 4 **Gently squish the mint** with a spoon — that releases the smell.
- 5 Pour lemon syrup over. Top up with cold sparkling water.
- 6 Stir once. Serve with a straw.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Squishing (not chopping) the mint releases the oils without making it bitter. Bartender trick.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Raspberry:** swap strawberries for raspberries. **Cucumber Moat:** add cucumber slices. **Hot Moat:** tiny dash of chilli powder.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

2

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 200ml water
- ♦ 2 tbsp ground coffee (medium grind)
- ♦ 30ml milk (or oat milk)
- ♦ ½ tsp sugar (optional)
- ♦ A tiny pinch of cinnamon

- 1 Boil water in the kettle, then let it sit for 30 seconds (perfect temp is 95°C, not 100°C).
- 2 Put ground coffee in a coffee press (cafetière).
- 3 Pour over the hot water. Stir gently with a spoon.
- 4 Pop the lid on (don't press yet). Wait 4 minutes — set a timer.
- 5 Slowly press the plunger down. Pour into a mug.
- 6 Warm the milk in the microwave 20 seconds. Pour in. Add sugar and cinnamon to taste.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Coffee for Mum or Dad is the kindest morning move. The 4-minute timer is what makes it taste GOOD instead of bitter.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Iced Brewsalot: pour the coffee over a glass of ice. **Vanilla:** add ½ tsp vanilla extract. **Sweet:** stir in a spoon of honey.

GLUTEN-FREE

Coffee is naturally GF. Use a GF-certified plant milk if you're really strict.

3

COINS

15 MIN + chill

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 3 digestive biscuits
- ◆ 15g butter, melted
- ◆ 150g cream cheese (full-fat — light won't set)
- ◆ 25g icing sugar
- ◆ ½ tsp vanilla extract
- ◆ 30ml double cream
- ◆ A handful of berries
- ◆ Mint leaf

- 1 Crush the biscuits in a bag with a rolling pin until fine. Mix with melted butter.
- 2 Press the buttery crumbs into the bottom of a jar or small glass.
- 3 In a bowl, whisk cream cheese, icing sugar, and vanilla until smooth.
- 4 Add the cream. Whisk again until thick and holds its shape.
- 5 Spoon the cream cheese mix on top of the biscuit base. Smooth the top.
- 6 **Chill at least 1 hour** — this lets it set so it's not soupy.
- 7 Top with berries and a mint leaf right before serving.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Full-fat cream cheese is non-negotiable — light versions are too wet and never set firm.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Chocolate: use chocolate biscuits and add 1 tbsp cocoa. **Lemon:** add zest of ½ lemon. **Cookies & Cream:** crumble Oreos through the filling.

GLUTEN-FREE

Use **GF digestive biscuits**. Everything else is naturally GF.

3

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 scoops vanilla ice cream
- ♦ 1 scoop chocolate ice cream
- ♦ 2 tbsp chocolate sauce
- ♦ 1 tbsp chopped toasted hazelnuts
- ♦ Whipped cream
- ♦ Cherry on top
- ♦ Wafer biscuit (optional)

- 1 **Toast the hazelnuts** in a dry pan 2 minutes — totally different flavor from raw.
- 2 In a tall glass or sundae bowl, scoop the vanilla first.
- 3 Drizzle 1 tbsp chocolate sauce.
- 4 Add the chocolate scoop. Drizzle the rest of the sauce.
- 5 Top with whipped cream piled high.
- 6 Sprinkle toasted hazelnuts. Cherry on top. Wafer on the side.
- 7 Serve immediately — frozen treasures melt fast.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Toasting nuts for just 2 minutes wakes up the flavor and makes them crunchier. Don't skip.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Banana Split:** add half a banana along the side. **Brownie Treasure:** add a warm brownie chunk. **Caramel Castle:** use caramel sauce instead of chocolate.

GLUTEN-FREE Skip the wafer or use a **GF biscuit**. Check the chocolate sauce label.

★ PART TWO ★



THE EXTENDED MENU

More fast food, salads, healthy swaps & snacks



15

ROYAL HOT DOG

Toasted bun · mustard · crispy onions

1

SERVES

3

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 good-quality hot dog sausage
- ◆ 1 hot dog bun
- ◆ 1 tsp butter
- ◆ American mustard
- ◆ Ketchup
- ◆ Crispy fried onions
- ◆ A few pickle slices (optional)

- 1 Boil water in a pan. Drop the sausage in. Turn the heat off. Let sit 6 minutes (gentle = no splits).
- 2 Butter the inside of the bun. Toast in a dry hot pan, butter-side down, 30 sec until golden.
- 3 Pull sausage out, pat dry.
- 4 Build: bun → mustard → sausage → ketchup zigzag → crispy onions → pickles.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Off-heat poaching keeps the sausage juicy. Hot boiling splits the skin and dries it out.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Chili Dog:** top with warm chili and grated cheese. **Cheese Dog:** add a slice of cheese while the sausage is hot. **NY style:** sauerkraut and brown mustard.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF hot dog bun**. Most plain sausages are GF — check the label.

3

COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 chicken breast
- ◆ ½ tsp olive oil
- ◆ ¼ tsp salt
- ◆ ¼ tsp smoked paprika
- ◆ ¼ tsp garlic powder
- ◆ Black pepper
- ◆ 1 large tortilla wrap
- ◆ A handful of shredded lettuce
- ◆ ½ tomato, chopped
- ◆ 2 tbsp ranch dressing
- ◆ 1 slice cheese (optional)

- 1 Bash the chicken between two sheets of paper to even 1cm thick — cooks faster, stays juicy.
- 2 Rub with oil, salt, paprika, garlic powder, and pepper.
- 3 Grill or pan-fry on medium-high 3 min per side. Rest 2 min, then slice.
- 4 Warm the tortilla in the same pan 20 sec each side — flexible wraps don't crack.
- 5 Lay tortilla flat. Spread ranch. Add lettuce, tomato, cheese, then chicken slices in a line.
- 6 Fold sides IN first, then roll tightly from the filling end.
- 7 Toast the seam-side down in the pan 1 min to seal.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Grilled chicken stays crisp-edged in a wrap. Breaded goes SOGGY by lunch — learn from the mistake.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** chipotle mayo instead of ranch. **Veggie:** swap chicken for grilled halloumi. **Caesar Wrap:** use Caesar dressing + parmesan.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF tortilla wrap** (corn or chickpea-based). Chicken and dressing are GF.

6

COINS

20 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 180g beef mince (3 x 60g patties)
- ♦ 3 mini slider buns
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ 1 tsp oil
- ♦ 1 slice cheddar (cut in 3)
- ♦ 1 tbsp BBQ sauce
- ♦ 1 tbsp royal sauce
- ♦ 3 pickle slices
- ♦ Crispy onions

- 1 Form 3 mini patties (60g each). Dimple each with your thumb. Salt and pepper both sides.
- 2 Heat oil in a pan on medium-high. Cook patties 2 minutes per side.
- 3 In the last 30 seconds, lay cheese pieces on top of each. Cover so they melt.
- 4 Toast the slider buns in the same pan.
- 5 Build each one differently:
- 6 **#1 Classic:** royal sauce + patty + pickle.
- 7 **#2 BBQ:** BBQ sauce + patty + crispy onions.
- 8 **#3 Cheesy:** extra cheese + patty + ketchup.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Three different builds is the wow move — looks like a real royal feast.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Veggie Trio:** use 3 small veggie patties. **Breakfast Trio:** add a quail egg on each. **Spicy:** add jalapeños to one.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF mini buns**. Check the BBQ sauce label.

3

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 tortillas
- ♦ 60g grated cheese (cheddar or mozzarella)
- ♦ 1 small handful cooked chicken, shredded (or black beans)
- ♦ 2 tbsp salsa
- ♦ ½ tsp butter
- ♦ Sour cream, to dip
- ♦ Optional: chopped spring onion, jalapeño

- 1 Lay one tortilla on a board. Sprinkle half the cheese.
- 2 Add chicken (or beans), salsa, and any optional toppings. Sprinkle the rest of the cheese on top.
- 3 Lay the second tortilla on top and press down gently.
- 4 Heat butter in a dry pan on medium. Slide the quesadilla in.
- 5 Cook 2-3 minutes until the bottom is golden. Flip carefully (use a plate to help).
- 6 Cook another 2-3 minutes. The cheese should be fully melted.
- 7 Slide onto a board. Cut into 6 wedges. Serve with sour cream.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Press down gently while cooking — that's what binds it together so it doesn't fall apart when you cut.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** add chopped jalapeños. **Pizza-**
dilla: use pizza sauce, mozzarella,
pepperoni. **Breakfast:** scrambled egg +
cheese + bacon.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF tortillas**. Filling is
naturally GF.

4

COINS

20 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 white fish fillet (cod or pollock, about 120g)
- ◆ 2 tbsp flour
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ ¼ tsp pepper
- ◆ 1 egg, beaten
- ◆ Royal Breadcrumbs (recipe #0a)
- ◆ 1 tbsp oil
- ◆ 1 brioche bun
- ◆ Lettuce leaf
- ◆ 3 tbsp mayonnaise + 1 tbsp finely chopped pickles + squeeze of lemon (tartar)
- ◆ A slice of lemon

- 1 Pat the fish VERY dry with kitchen paper. Wet fish = soggy coating.
- 2 Mix the tartar: mayo + pickles + lemon. Set aside.
- 3 Set up 3 plates: seasoned flour · egg · breadcrumbs.
- 4 Coat the fish: flour → egg → breadcrumbs. Press in firmly.
- 5 Heat oil in a pan on medium. Fry the fish 3 min per side until golden and cooked through.
- 6 Toast the bun.
- 7 Build: bun → tartar → lettuce → crispy fish → squeeze of lemon → top bun.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Drying the fish is what makes the breading STICK and crisp. Wet fish slides out of its coat.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** mix cayenne into the flour. **Cheese:** add a slice of cheese. **Po-boy:** use a baguette and add shredded lettuce + tomato.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF flour**, **GF royal breadcrumbs**, and a **GF bun**.

3

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 slices sourdough or thick white bread
- ♦ 1 tbsp butter, soft
- ♦ 1 slice cheddar
- ♦ 1 slice mozzarella (or 30g grated)
- ♦ 1 slice gruyère or Emmental
- ♦ Pinch of mustard powder (secret!)
- ♦ A few chopped chives (optional)

- 1 Butter the OUTSIDE of both slices of bread (yes, outside — this is the grilled-cheese rule).
- 2 Lay one slice butter-side DOWN in a cold pan.
- 3 Sprinkle the mustard powder on the inside (it makes cheese taste cheesier — promise).
- 4 Layer: cheddar, mozzarella, gruyère, chives. Top with second slice, butter-side UP.
- 5 Turn heat to LOW. Cook 4 min until bottom is deep golden.
- 6 Flip carefully. Cook another 3-4 min — patience! Low and slow melts the cheese before the bread burns.
- 7 Slice diagonally and serve hot.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ LOW HEAT is the rule. High heat = burnt bread with cold cheese inside. Diner cooks always go low.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Ham & Cheese:** add ham. **Tomato:** add tomato slice. **French:** dip in beaten egg before frying (croque-monsieur style).

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF bread**. All the cheese is naturally GF.

5

COINS

45 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 8 chicken wings (about 600g)
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ 1 tsp baking powder (the SECRET — extra crispy)
- ◆ ¼ tsp black pepper
- ◆ ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ◆ ½ tsp garlic powder
- ◆ 2 tbsp hot sauce
- ◆ 2 tbsp honey
- ◆ 1 tbsp butter
- ◆ 1 tsp soy sauce
- ◆ Spring onions to garnish

- 1 Heat oven to 220°C. Line a tray with baking paper.
- 2 Pat the wings VERY dry with kitchen paper.
- 3 Mix salt + **baking powder** + pepper + paprika + garlic powder in a bowl. Toss the wings in it.
- 4 (The baking powder is the diner trick — it makes them extra crispy in the oven without frying.)
- 5 Lay wings on the tray, NOT touching each other.
- 6 Bake 35 minutes, flipping once at the halfway mark.
- 7 Mix hot sauce + honey + melted butter + soy in a big bowl.
- 8 Pull wings out, tip them straight into the sauce bowl. Toss to coat.
- 9 Sprinkle with spring onion. Eat with napkins — it gets messy.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ The teaspoon of baking powder is the secret behind every great oven wing recipe. It dries the skin and crisps it up like deep-frying.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **BBQ:** swap hot sauce for BBQ. **Honey-Garlic:** 3 tbsp honey + 1 tsp grated garlic + soy. **Lemon-Pepper:** butter + lemon zest + lots of pepper.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF soy sauce** (tamari). Check hot sauce label. Wings are naturally GF.

22

KNIGHT'S GARDEN

Mixed green salad with vinaigrette

1

SERVES

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 100g mixed leaves (rocket, baby spinach, lamb's lettuce)
- ◆ 1 small cucumber, sliced
- ◆ 8 cherry tomatoes, halved
- ◆ ¼ red onion, very thin slices
- ◆ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ 1 tbsp red wine vinegar
- ◆ ½ tsp Dijon mustard
- ◆ ½ tsp honey
- ◆ Salt & pepper

- 1 **Soak the red onion slices in cold water 5 min** — this takes out the harsh bite (chef trick).
- 2 Wash and dry the leaves. WET salad = sad salad. Use a salad spinner or pat dry with a tea towel.
- 3 In a jar, shake oil + vinegar + mustard + honey + salt + pepper until creamy.
- 4 In a big bowl, gently mix leaves, cucumber, tomatoes, and drained onion.
- 5 **Dress just before serving** — dressed salad goes limp fast.
- 6 Toss with hands (gentler than tongs). Serve in a wide bowl.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Soaking the onion in cold water is the trick — it makes raw onion taste sweet instead of sharp.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **With Feta:** crumble 50g feta on top.
With Nuts: add a handful of toasted walnuts. **Sweet:** add slices of apple or pear.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ ¼ small white cabbage, very finely shredded
- ◆ 1 carrot, grated
- ◆ ¼ red onion, very thin slices
- ◆ 3 tbsp mayonnaise
- ◆ 1 tbsp natural yoghurt
- ◆ 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- ◆ 1 tsp apple cider vinegar
- ◆ ½ tsp honey
- ◆ ½ tsp celery seeds (the slaw secret)
- ◆ Salt & pepper

- 1 Salt the shredded cabbage with ¼ tsp salt. Let sit 5 minutes — pulls out water (no soggy slaw).
- 2 Squeeze the cabbage in your hands over the sink to drain.
- 3 Mix mayo, yoghurt, mustard, vinegar, honey, celery seeds, salt, and pepper in a big bowl.
- 4 Add cabbage, carrot, and onion. Toss really well.
- 5 **Best after 30 min in the fridge** — the flavors marry, the texture improves.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Salting and squeezing the cabbage first is the difference between deli slaw and watery sad slaw.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Apple Slaw:** add a grated apple. **Asian Slaw:** swap vinegar for rice vinegar, add sesame oil and seeds. **Spicy:** add chopped jalapeño.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

3

COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 head romaine lettuce
- ◆ 2 slices stale bread (for croutons)
- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ ½ clove garlic
- ◆ 30g parmesan, shaved
- ◆ 3 tbsp mayonnaise
- ◆ 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- ◆ 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce (secret umami!)
- ◆ 1 small clove garlic, grated
- ◆ 1 tsp lemon juice
- ◆ Black pepper

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C. Cut bread into cubes. Toss with oil and rub the cut garlic over them.
- 2 Bake 10 min until golden and crunchy. Cool on tray.
- 3 Mix mayo + mustard + Worcestershire + grated garlic + lemon + lots of pepper for the dressing.
- 4 Wash and dry romaine VERY well (wet leaves = watered-down dressing). Tear into bite pieces.
- 5 In a big bowl: leaves + half the parmesan + half the croutons + dressing. Toss.
- 6 Pile in a bowl. Top with remaining parmesan and croutons. Extra pepper on top.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Worcestershire sauce is the secret umami in Caesar. Without it, the dressing tastes flat.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Chicken Caesar:** add sliced grilled chicken. **Anchovy:** mash 2 anchovies into the dressing (classic!). **Bacon Caesar:** add crispy bacon bits.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF bread** for croutons. Check the Worcestershire label.

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 200g broccoli florets
- ♦ 150g green beans, trimmed
- ♦ 1 tbsp butter
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ Zest of ½ lemon
- ♦ 1 tbsp toasted almond flakes
- ♦ Pinch of chilli flakes (optional)

- 1 Bring a pan of salted water to the boil.
- 2 Add the green beans first. After 1 minute, add the broccoli.
- 3 Cook 3 more minutes — should still be bright green and slightly crunchy.
- 4 Drain. **Immediately tip into ice water** to stop the cooking and keep them green.
- 5 Drain again. Toss in a warm pan with butter, salt, lemon zest, and chilli (if using).
- 6 Tip onto a plate. Scatter toasted almonds on top.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Ice water shock is what makes vegetables stay **BRIGHT** green. Without it they go army-green and limp.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Garlic:** add a grated garlic clove with the butter. **Parmesan:** sprinkle grated parmesan. **Soy:** swap butter for soy + sesame oil + sesame seeds.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

3

COINS

40 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 3 large potatoes (skin on, scrubbed)
- ♦ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ ¼ tsp pepper
- ♦ ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ♦ ½ tsp dried rosemary (or 1 tsp fresh, chopped)
- ♦ ½ tsp garlic powder

- 1 Heat oven to 220°C. Line a tray with paper.
- 2 Cut each potato in half lengthways, then each half into 3-4 wedges.
- 3 **Soak in cold water 10 min** if you have time — crispier.
- 4 Drain. Dry VERY well with a tea towel.
- 5 Toss with oil, salt, pepper, paprika, rosemary, and garlic powder.
- 6 Spread on tray, skin-side down. Don't crowd.
- 7 Bake 30 min, flipping once. Crispy outside, fluffy inside.
- 8 Serve with royal sauce or sour cream.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Skin-on with rosemary is the pub-classic flavor. Skin gives crunch AND keeps the inside fluffy.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Cajun:** add cayenne + thyme + oregano. **Parmesan:** toss with grated parmesan in the last 5 min. **Loaded:** top with cheese, bacon, sour cream.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

SWEET POTATO FRIES

Crispy sweet potato fries · smoky salt

3

COINS

35 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 medium sweet potatoes
- ♦ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ♦ 1 tbsp cornflour (THE secret — makes them crispy)
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ ¼ tsp smoked paprika
- ♦ ¼ tsp garlic powder
- ♦ Black pepper

- 1 Heat oven to 220°C. Line a tray with paper.
- 2 Cut sweet potatoes into 1cm thick fries. Pat very dry.
- 3 **Toss with the cornflour FIRST** — this is what makes them crispy (sweet potato fries are usually floppy without this trick).
- 4 Then toss with oil, salt, paprika, garlic powder, and pepper.
- 5 Spread on tray in a single layer, NOT touching.
- 6 Bake 15 min. Flip carefully. Bake 10 min more.
- 7 Sprinkle smoked salt while hot. Serve with sour cream or royal sauce.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Cornflour is the secret weapon for sweet potato fries — they're wetter than regular potatoes and need help getting crispy.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** add cayenne. **Sweet:** sprinkle cinnamon-sugar after baking. **Herby:** add dried thyme.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF (cornflour is corn-based, not wheat).

29

STRAWBERRY SHAKE

Vanilla ice cream · fresh strawberries

1

SERVES

3

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 3 scoops vanilla ice cream
- ♦ 120g strawberries (fresh or frozen)
- ♦ 60ml whole milk
- ♦ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ♦ Tiny pinch of salt
- ♦ Whipped cream
- ♦ Fresh strawberry to garnish

- 1 Put ice cream, strawberries, milk, vanilla, and salt in a blender.
- 2 Blitz 30 seconds. Should be thick — if too thick, add 1 tbsp more milk.
- 3 Pour into a tall glass.
- 4 Top with whipped cream. Slice a strawberry and perch it on the rim.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Frozen strawberries make a thicker shake than fresh — use frozen if you have them.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Banana:** swap strawberries for ½ frozen banana. **Berry:** use mixed berries. **Boozy (adults):** add 1 tbsp strawberry liqueur.

GLUTEN-FREE Check ice cream label. Most are GF.

30

VANILLA SHAKE

Classic vanilla milkshake

1

SERVES

3

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 4 scoops vanilla ice cream (good quality!)
- ♦ 60ml whole milk
- ♦ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ♦ Tiny pinch of salt
- ♦ Whipped cream
- ♦ Sprinkles

- 1 Put ice cream, milk, vanilla, and salt in a blender.
- 2 Blitz 30 seconds until thick and creamy.
- 3 Pour into a tall glass.
- 4 Top with whipped cream and rainbow sprinkles.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Vanilla shake is only as good as the ice cream — splash out on good vanilla. The pinch of salt makes it taste richer.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Cookie shake: blend in 2 crumbled biscuits. **Malted:** add 1 tsp malted milk powder (Horlicks). **Caramel:** swirl caramel sauce into the glass.

GLUTEN-FREE

Check ice cream label. Most vanilla ice creams are GF.

3

COINS

15 MIN + chill

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 120g rolled oats
- ◆ 3 tbsp peanut butter (or almond butter)
- ◆ 3 tbsp honey
- ◆ 2 tbsp cocoa powder
- ◆ 1 tbsp dark chocolate chips
- ◆ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ◆ Pinch of salt

- 1 Tip oats into a big bowl.
- 2 Add peanut butter, honey, cocoa, chocolate chips, vanilla, and salt.
- 3 Mix with a spoon until it forms a sticky dough — if too dry, add 1 tsp more honey.
- 4 Roll into 10 walnut-size balls with your hands (slightly wet hands = less sticky).
- 5 **Chill 30 min** to firm up.
- 6 Store in a tub in the fridge. Last 1 week.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Wet hands stops the mix sticking.
Or wear food-safe gloves.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Coconut:** roll the balls in desiccated coconut. **Seeds:** add 1 tbsp chia or flax seeds. **Berry:** swap chocolate for dried cranberries.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **certified GF oats** — regular oats can be contaminated with wheat.



GARDEN KNIGHT

Hearty veggie burger · black beans · oats



4

COINS

25 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 tin black beans (240g drained)
- ◆ 40g rolled oats
- ◆ ½ small onion, grated
- ◆ 1 clove garlic, grated
- ◆ ½ tsp cumin
- ◆ ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ 1 tbsp ketchup
- ◆ 1 small egg
- ◆ 1 tbsp oil
- ◆ 2 burger buns
- ◆ Cheese, lettuce, sauce, pickles

- 1 **Drain beans and dry on kitchen paper 5 min** — soggy beans = falling-apart patties.
- 2 In a bowl, mash beans roughly with a fork (leave some chunks for texture).
- 3 Add oats, grated onion, garlic, cumin, paprika, salt, ketchup, and egg.
- 4 Mix well. Should hold together when squeezed. Let sit 5 min so oats absorb.
- 5 Form into 2 patties.
- 6 Heat oil in a pan on medium. Cook patties 4 min per side until golden and firm.
- 7 Toast buns. Build like any burger: bun → sauce → patty → cheese → lettuce → pickles → bun.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Drying the beans is the secret to a veggie burger that doesn't fall apart. Most veggie burgers fail here.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** add a chopped jalapeño. **Mushroom:** add 50g chopped mushrooms (cooked first). **BBQ:** use BBQ sauce instead of ketchup.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **certified GF oats** and a **GF bun**.

4

COINS

25 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 chicken breasts (240g)
- ♦ 2 tbsp Greek yoghurt
- ♦ 1 tsp lemon juice
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ ¼ tsp pepper
- ♦ ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ♦ ¼ tsp garlic powder
- ♦ ¼ tsp dried oregano
- ♦ 1 tbsp olive oil

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C. Line a tray with paper, brush with oil.
- 2 Cut chicken into nugget-size pieces (about 3cm).
- 3 Mix yoghurt + lemon + salt + pepper + paprika + garlic + oregano in a bowl.
- 4 **Toss the chicken in the yoghurt** and leave 5 min — yoghurt is the marinade trick that keeps it juicy.
- 5 Lay nuggets on the tray, not touching.
- 6 Bake 15 min. Flip. Bake 5 more min until golden.
- 7 Serve with veggie sticks and dip.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Yoghurt marinade is the chef secret for juicy, tender chicken — works better than any breading.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Indian:** add ½ tsp curry powder. **BBQ:** add 1 tbsp BBQ sauce to the marinade. **Lemon-Pepper:** double the lemon and pepper.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

3

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 large wholemeal tortilla
- ◆ 2 tbsp hummus
- ◆ A small handful of spinach
- ◆ ½ carrot, grated
- ◆ ¼ cucumber, sliced lengthways
- ◆ ¼ red pepper, sliced
- ◆ 60g cooked chicken or chickpeas
- ◆ 1 tsp olive oil
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ Squeeze of lemon

- 1 Warm the wrap in a dry pan 20 seconds each side — flexible wraps don't crack.
- 2 Lay flat on a board. Spread hummus all over, leaving a 2cm border.
- 3 In a line down the middle: spinach, then carrot, cucumber, pepper, chicken.
- 4 Drizzle olive oil, squeeze of lemon, pinch of salt.
- 5 Fold sides in, then roll tight from the filling end.
- 6 Cut in half on the diagonal.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Layering veggies in a LINE down the middle (not spread out) is what makes a wrap that holds together.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Falafel:** use 2 falafel balls instead of chicken. **Greek:** add olives and feta. **Spicy:** add sriracha or chilli flakes.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF wrap**. Hummus and veggies are naturally GF.

S1

KNIGHT'S POPCORN

Stovetop popcorn · royal seasoning

1

SERVES

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 60g popcorn kernels
- ◆ 2 tbsp neutral oil (sunflower or coconut)
- ◆ 2 tbsp melted butter
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ ¼ tsp smoked paprika
- ◆ ¼ tsp garlic powder
- ◆ 1 tbsp grated parmesan (optional)

- 1 Heat oil in a big pan with a lid on medium-high.
- 2 Drop in 3 test kernels. When they pop, add the rest.
- 3 Quickly cover with the lid. Shake the pan from time to time.
- 4 Listen — when the popping slows to a pop every 2 seconds, turn off the heat.
- 5 Tip into a big bowl.
- 6 Drizzle melted butter. Sprinkle salt, paprika, garlic powder, and parmesan if using.
- 7 Toss with your hands (wash them first) — coats every kernel.

★ ROYAL TIP ★ Listening to the pops is the trick — don't open the lid! The slowdown is the signal.

★ MIX IT UP ★ **Sweet:** drizzle melted butter + 2 tbsp sugar + ½ tsp cinnamon. **Cheesy:** 2 tbsp nutritional yeast. **Salt & Vinegar:** spray with white wine vinegar + salt.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.



ROYAL DIP TRIO

Hummus · guacamole · salsa



COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

HUMMUS

- ◆ 1 tin chickpeas (240g drained)
- ◆ 2 tbsp tahini
- ◆ Juice of ½ lemon
- ◆ 1 small garlic clove
- ◆ 3 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ 3 tbsp ICE WATER (the secret!)
- ◆ ½ tsp salt

GUACAMOLE

- ◆ 1 ripe avocado
- ◆ ½ small tomato, chopped
- ◆ ¼ small onion, finely chopped
- ◆ Juice of ½ lime
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ A few coriander leaves

SALSA

- ◆ 2 tomatoes, chopped
- ◆ ¼ red onion, finely chopped
- ◆ Juice of ½ lime
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ Pinch of cumin

- 1 HUMMUS:** Blitz chickpeas + tahini + lemon + garlic + salt + oil + ICE WATER in a food processor. Ice water is the chef secret — makes it fluffy like restaurant hummus.
- 2 GUACAMOLE:** Mash avocado with a fork. Stir in tomato, onion, lime, salt, coriander.
- 3 SALSA:** Mix all ingredients in a bowl. Let sit 5 min for flavors to come together.
- 4** Serve all three in small bowls with tortilla chips, veggie sticks, or pitta.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Ice water in hummus is THE secret. Restaurants do it, home cooks rarely know. Makes it light and fluffy.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Hot Hummus:** add ½ tsp cayenne.
Loaded Guac: add chopped jalapeño.
Sweet Salsa: add diced mango.

GLUTEN-FREE All three dips are naturally GF.
Serve with GF chips or veggie sticks.



CASTLE CHIPS

Crispy oven tortilla chips · salt & lime



COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 4 corn tortillas
- ◆ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ Zest of ½ lime (the secret zing)
- ◆ Pinch of cumin
- ◆ Pinch of smoked paprika

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C. Line a tray with baking paper.
- 2 Cut each tortilla into 6 wedges (like a pizza).
- 3 In a bowl, toss with oil, salt, lime zest, cumin, and paprika.
- 4 Spread on the tray in a single layer — not stacked.
- 5 Bake 10 min. They're ready when golden and crisp.
- 6 Cool on the tray 2 min — they crisp up more.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Lime zest with salt is the genius combo — gives chips a fresh flavor you can't identify but you can't stop eating.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Cinnamon-sugar:** swap salt mix for cinnamon-sugar (sweet snack!). **Spicy:** add cayenne. **Garlic:** add garlic powder.

GLUTEN-FREE Corn tortillas are naturally GF — but check the label as some have wheat added.

★ PART THREE ★



THE ROYAL BREAKFAST

Served until 11:00 · start the kingdom right

★ ★ ★

B1

CASTLE EGGS

Creamy scrambled eggs · chives · toast

1

SERVES

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 3 eggs
- ♦ 1 tbsp butter
- ♦ 1 tbsp milk or cream
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ 1 tsp finely chopped chives
- ♦ 2 slices toast
- ♦ Butter for the toast

- 1 Crack eggs into a bowl. Add milk. Whisk well — yolks and whites must be ONE color.
- 2 Melt butter in a pan on the LOWEST heat. Pour eggs in.
- 3 **LOW heat is the secret.** Stir GENTLY with a wooden spoon, pulling from the edges.
- 4 After 3-4 minutes you should have soft curds that look slightly wet.
- 5 Take off heat WHILE STILL WET — they keep cooking in the pan.
- 6 Stir in chives, salt, and pepper. Serve immediately on toast.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ LOW and SLOW is the rule. Rushing scrambled eggs = rubber. Patience = restaurant-creamy.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Cheesy:** sprinkle grated cheddar in the last 30 sec. **Smoked salmon:** stir in flaked salmon at the end. **Garlic-mushroom:** serve with fried garlic mushrooms.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF bread** for toast. Eggs are naturally GF.



ROYAL PANCAKES

Fluffy American pancakes · maple syrup

8 small
pancakes
SERVES

3

COINS

20 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 150g plain flour
- ◆ 2 tsp baking powder (DOUBLE for super fluffy)
- ◆ 2 tbsp sugar
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ 1 large egg
- ◆ 200ml milk
- ◆ 30g melted butter
- ◆ ½ tsp vanilla extract
- ◆ Butter for the pan
- ◆ Maple syrup & berries to serve

- 1 In a bowl, whisk flour, baking powder, sugar, and salt.
- 2 In a jug, whisk egg, milk, melted butter, and vanilla.
- 3 Pour wet into dry. Stir JUST until combined — lumps are OK! **Overmixed = tough pancakes.**
- 4 **Let the batter rest 5 min** — this is how diners get them puffy.
- 5 Heat butter in a pan on medium-low. Spoon in dollops of batter (about 2 tbsp each).
- 6 Cook until bubbles form on top and edges look set (about 2 min). Flip.
- 7 Cook another 1-2 min on the other side. Keep warm in a low oven while you do the rest.
- 8 Stack high. Pour over maple syrup. Top with berries.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Two teaspoons of baking powder (not one) is the diner secret for fluffy pancakes. Plus the 5-min rest.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Choc chip:** drop chocolate chips on each pancake just after pouring. **Banana:** press banana slices into the batter. **Lemon Ricotta:** swap 50g flour for ricotta + add lemon zest.

GLUTEN-FREE Swap flour for **GF flour blend** + ½ tsp extra baking powder. Same technique, same fluffy result.



ROYAL TOAST

French toast · cinnamon · berries



COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 4 slices day-old thick bread (brioche or sourdough)
- ◆ 2 eggs
- ◆ 100ml milk
- ◆ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ◆ 1 tsp cinnamon
- ◆ 1 tbsp sugar
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ 2 tbsp butter
- ◆ Maple syrup, berries, icing sugar to serve

- 1 **Day-old bread works better than fresh** — drier bread soaks up the custard without going soggy.
- 2 In a wide dish, whisk eggs + milk + vanilla + cinnamon + sugar + salt.
- 3 Dip each slice in the egg mix for 10 seconds per side — soaked but not falling apart.
- 4 Heat butter in a pan on medium. Lay 2 slices in.
- 5 Cook 2 min per side until deep golden and slightly crispy.
- 6 Stack on plates. Dust with icing sugar.
- 7 Pour maple syrup. Pile berries on top.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Stale bread is BETTER for French toast — fresh bread turns to mush. Save your bread heels for this.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Stuffed:** sandwich two slices with cream cheese before dipping. **Cocoa:** add 1 tbsp cocoa to the egg mix. **Savory:** skip sugar, top with bacon.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF bread**. Same technique, same delicious result.

2

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 50g rolled oats
- ◆ 180ml milk (or oat milk)
- ◆ Tiny pinch of salt
- ◆ 1 tsp honey
- ◆ 1 tbsp chopped walnuts or pecans
- ◆ ½ banana, sliced
- ◆ A few berries
- ◆ Pinch of cinnamon

- 1 **Toast the nuts** in a dry pan 1-2 min until smelling toasty. Tip out.
- 2 In the same pan, put oats, milk, and salt. Bring to a gentle simmer.
- 3 Stir frequently for 4-5 minutes until thick and creamy. **Less milk than you think** — this is breakfast, not soup.
- 4 Take off the heat. Stir in the honey.
- 5 Pour into a bowl. Top with banana, berries, toasted nuts, and a dust of cinnamon.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Toasting the nuts for 2 minutes turns boring porridge into something restaurant-worthy. Always toast nuts first.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Apple-pie:** stir in grated apple + cinnamon. **Chocolate:** stir in 1 tsp cocoa + chocolate chips. **Peanut Butter:** swirl in 1 tbsp PB.

GLUTEN-FREE Use *certified GF* oats.



SUNRISE WRAP

Scrambled egg · cheese · tortilla



COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 eggs
- ♦ 1 tbsp milk
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ 1 tsp butter
- ♦ 1 large tortilla wrap
- ♦ 30g grated cheese
- ♦ 2 strips cooked bacon (optional)
- ♦ 1 tbsp salsa or ketchup
- ♦ A few spinach leaves

- 1 Whisk eggs, milk, salt, and pepper.
- 2 Melt butter in a pan on low heat. Pour in eggs.
- 3 Stir gently 2 min until just set but still soft.
- 4 Warm the tortilla in a separate dry pan 20 sec each side.
- 5 Lay tortilla flat. Spread salsa.
- 6 Put spinach, then eggs, then cheese (residual heat melts it), then bacon in a line.
- 7 Fold sides in, roll tight. Toast seam-side down for 30 sec to seal.
- 8 Cut in half on the diagonal.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Put cheese ON the hot eggs, not the cold tortilla — residual heat melts it perfectly.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Veggie:** swap bacon for grilled mushrooms. **Spicy:** add hot sauce or jalapeños. **Avocado:** add slices of avo.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF tortilla**. Eggs, cheese, bacon are GF.



FULL ROYAL PLATE

Eggs · bacon · beans · tomato · toast



COINS

25 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 4 eggs
- ◆ 4 strips bacon
- ◆ 2 good-quality sausages
- ◆ 4 small tomatoes (or 2 normal, halved)
- ◆ 1 small tin baked beans
- ◆ 4 small mushrooms, sliced
- ◆ 1 tbsp butter
- ◆ 1 tbsp oil
- ◆ 4 slices toast
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ Ketchup or HP sauce

- 1 Heat oven to 100°C – to keep things warm as you go.
- 2 Heat oven for tomatoes: pop on a tray with oil, salt, pepper. Roast at 200°C for 12 min. (Use a small dish so they fit.)
- 3 Meanwhile, fry sausages in oil 8 min, turning, until golden. Move to oven-warm plate.
- 4 Same pan, fry bacon until crispy 3 min per side. Onto plate.
- 5 Same pan again, fry mushrooms in the bacon fat 3 min. Onto plate.
- 6 Wipe pan. Melt butter. Crack eggs in. Fry sunny-side up 3 min. Lid on for 30 sec to set tops.
- 7 Warm beans in a small pan.
- 8 Toast bread. Serve everything together. Hot pan, hot plate, hot food – that's the British breakfast rule.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Use ONE pan throughout – bacon fat flavors the mushrooms, butter from eggs goes onto the toast.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Veggie:** swap bacon and sausage for halloumi and avocado. **American:** add hash browns and pancakes. **Hash:** add fried potato cubes.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF sausages**, **GF bread**, and check the beans label.



HASH BROWNS

Crispy potato patties · golden & fluffy



3

COINS

25 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 2 large potatoes (waxy is best)
- ♦ ¼ small onion, grated
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ ¼ tsp pepper
- ♦ ¼ tsp onion powder (secret flavor!)
- ♦ 1 tbsp flour
- ♦ 1 egg
- ♦ 2 tbsp oil for frying

- 1 Grate potatoes (skin off). Tip into a clean tea towel.
- 2 **Squeeze HARD over the sink.** Get out as much water as humanly possible — this is the crispy secret.
- 3 Tip into a bowl. Mix in grated onion, salt, pepper, onion powder, flour, and egg.
- 4 Heat oil in a pan on medium. Drop 4 dollops (about ½ cup each). Flatten with a spatula.
- 5 Cook 4 min until deep golden. Flip carefully. Cook another 4 min.
- 6 Drain on kitchen paper. Sprinkle salt while hot.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Squeezing the water out is the EVERYTHING step. Wet potato = soggy hash brown, no matter how long you fry.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Cheesy:** mix in 30g grated cheddar. **Loaded:** top with sour cream, bacon, spring onion. **Sweet Potato:** swap for sweet potato.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF flour** (or cornflour). Same crispy result.

B8

CROWN CROISSANT

Stuffed croissant · ham · cheese

1

SERVES

3

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 large butter croissant
- ◆ 1 slice ham
- ◆ 1 slice cheese (gruyère or cheddar)
- ◆ ½ tsp Dijon mustard (optional)
- ◆ 1 tsp butter

- 1 Heat oven to 180°C.
- 2 Slice the croissant in half horizontally — like a sandwich, not all the way through.
- 3 Spread Dijon on the bottom half (if using).
- 4 Layer ham, then cheese. Close the croissant.
- 5 **Lightly butter the top.**
- 6 Bake on a tray 5 min until cheese is melted and the outside is crispy.
- 7 Eat immediately — best when still flaky.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Lightly buttering the top makes it go extra golden and crispy in the oven. Bakery-style finish.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Almond:** spread Nutella + almond flakes. **Egg:** add a fried egg. **Veggie:** spinach + mozzarella + tomato.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF croissant** (or GF roll).
Ham and cheese are GF.



THE MUFFIN

Blueberry breakfast muffins · lemon zest



3

COINS

30 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 200g plain flour
- ♦ 1½ tsp baking powder
- ♦ ½ tsp baking soda
- ♦ Pinch of salt
- ♦ 100g sugar
- ♦ Zest of 1 lemon (the secret!)
- ♦ 1 egg
- ♦ 150ml milk
- ♦ 60g melted butter
- ♦ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ♦ 100g blueberries (fresh or frozen)
- ♦ 1 tbsp extra sugar for topping

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C. Line a muffin tin with 6 cases.
- 2 In a bowl: flour + baking powder + baking soda + salt + sugar + **LEMON ZEST**. Whisk together. (Lemon zest is the secret — wakes up blueberry flavor.)
- 3 In a jug: egg + milk + melted butter + vanilla.
- 4 Pour wet into dry. Stir **JUST** until mixed — lumps are fine. Overmixing = tough muffins.
- 5 Gently fold in the blueberries.
- 6 Spoon into cases (almost full). Sprinkle extra sugar on top.
- 7 Bake 18-20 min until golden and a stick comes out clean. Cool 5 min in tin.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Lemon zest with blueberries is the bakery secret — makes the berries taste **MORE** like berries.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Choc chip:** swap blueberries for chocolate chips. **Banana:** mash 1 ripe banana into wet mix. **Streusel top:** mix 2 tbsp butter + 3 tbsp flour + 2 tbsp sugar, crumble on top.

GLUTEN-FREE Swap flour for **GF flour blend** + ½ tsp xanthan gum (if your blend doesn't have it).



CASTLE BAGEL

Toasted bagel · cream cheese · jam



2

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 1 bagel
- ♦ 3 tbsp cream cheese (full-fat)
- ♦ 1 tbsp strawberry jam
- ♦ Optional: a few fresh berries

- 1 Slice the bagel in half.
- 2 Toast both halves in a toaster until golden (cut-side up under a grill works too).
- 3 While still warm, spread cream cheese on the bottom half — the warmth makes it softer.
- 4 Add a generous spoon of jam on top of the cream cheese.
- 5 Top with berries (optional). Put the other half on top.
- 6 Cut in half if you want.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Warm bagel + cold cream cheese is the contrast that makes this magic. Don't let the bagel cool too much.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Savory:** cream cheese + smoked salmon + capers. **Egg:** cream cheese + fried egg + spring onion. **Honey:** cream cheese + honey + walnuts.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF bagel**. Cream cheese and jam are GF.



YOGHURT TOWER

Greek yoghurt · granola · berries · honey



3

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 200g Greek yoghurt (the thick stuff)
- ♦ 3 tbsp granola
- ♦ 1 tbsp honey or maple syrup
- ♦ A handful of mixed berries
- ♦ 1 tsp toasted seeds (pumpkin or sunflower)
- ♦ A tiny pinch of salt

- 1 Take a tall glass or jar.
- 2 Layer: yoghurt → drizzle honey → granola → berries.
- 3 Repeat: yoghurt → granola → berries.
- 4 Top with seeds and another drizzle of honey.
- 5 **Pinch of salt on top** — sounds weird, but it makes honey taste sweeter.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ A tiny pinch of salt on sweet things is a chef trick — it makes the sweetness pop without tasting salty.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Apple-pie:** add cooked apple slices + cinnamon. **Choc Tower:** add chocolate chips. **Tropical:** swap berries for mango + coconut.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **certified GF granola**. Yoghurt, berries, honey are GF.

B13

ROYAL HOT CHOC

Real hot chocolate · not from a packet

1
SERVES

3

COINS

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 250ml whole milk
- ♦ 40g dark chocolate (70%), chopped
- ♦ 1 tbsp cocoa powder
- ♦ 1 tbsp sugar
- ♦ ½ tsp vanilla extract
- ♦ Tiny pinch of salt
- ♦ Whipped cream and mini marshmallows

- 1 Pour milk into a small pan. Heat on medium until JUST starting to steam (not boiling).
- 2 Whisk in the cocoa powder and sugar. Keep whisking – no lumps.
- 3 Drop in the chopped chocolate. Whisk gently until totally melted and smooth.
- 4 Take off heat. Whisk in vanilla and that **tiny pinch of salt**.
- 5 Pour into a mug. Top with whipped cream and a few marshmallows.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Real chocolate + cocoa together is what makes this a CASTLE hot chocolate. Just one or the other is fine. Both is restaurant-quality.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spiced:** add a pinch of cinnamon or chilli. **Mint:** 2 drops peppermint extract. **Salted Caramel:** swirl caramel sauce and extra flaky salt on top.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF. Just check the chocolate label.



KNIGHT'S TEA

A proper cup of English tea



2

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 1 tea bag (English Breakfast or Earl Grey)
- ♦ 200ml freshly boiled water
- ♦ 30ml milk
- ♦ Sugar to taste (optional)

- 1 Warm the mug first — pour in hot water, swirl, tip out. (Warm mug = hotter tea.)
- 2 Drop in the tea bag.
- 3 Pour over the freshly boiled water — important: **fresh** boil, not reheated.
- 4 Let it steep for 3 minutes. Set a timer.
- 5 Squeeze the tea bag gently with a spoon. Lift out.
- 6 Pour in the milk LAST (UK debate — but milk first changes the temperature).
- 7 Add sugar if you like. Stir once.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Warm the mug first. Tiny step. Massive difference. This is what makes café tea taste better than your home tea.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Iced:** brew double-strong, pour over a glass of ice. **Chai:** add a pinch of cinnamon and cardamom. **Lemon:** swap milk for a slice of lemon and honey.

GLUTEN-FREE Tea is naturally GF.



ORANGE JUICE

Fresh-squeezed · with the pulp



2

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 3 large oranges (the juicy kind — like Valencia)
- ♦ Ice cubes
- ♦ A pinch of salt (yes! the secret)

- 1 Roll the oranges firmly on the counter under your palm — this breaks the juice sacs inside so MORE juice comes out.
- 2 Cut each one in half across the middle (not pole to pole).
- 3 Squeeze with a hand juicer or by hand, over a bowl with a strainer.
- 4 Pour into a glass with ice.
- 5 Add a tiny pinch of salt. Trust the process.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Rolling the oranges first releases up to 30% more juice. And the pinch of salt makes them taste sweeter, not saltier.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Sunrise:** add a splash of pineapple juice. **Fizzy:** top with sparkling water. **Berry:** blend in a handful of berries.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.



BERRY ROYALE

Mixed berry smoothie



3

COINS

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 150g frozen mixed berries
- ◆ ½ banana
- ◆ 200ml milk (or oat milk)
- ◆ 2 tbsp Greek yoghurt
- ◆ 1 tbsp honey
- ◆ Tiny pinch of salt

- 1 Put everything in a blender.
- 2 Blitz on high for 30 seconds until completely smooth.
- 3 Taste — add more honey if you want it sweeter.
- 4 Pour into a tall glass. Maybe a straw and a berry on top.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Frozen berries make a thick cold smoothie without needing ice (ice waters it down).

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Green:** add a small handful of spinach (you won't taste it). **Tropical:** swap berries for mango + pineapple. **Power:** add 1 tbsp peanut butter + 1 tsp chia seeds.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

1

COINS

1 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 250ml cold milk (whole milk = best)
- ♦ A clean glass
- ♦ (Pinch of cinnamon, optional)

- 1 Keep the milk in the COLDEST part of the fridge (back, not the door).
- 2 Use a glass that's been chilled in the freezer for 5 min if you have time.
- 3 Pour milk in slowly. Don't splash.
- 4 Optional: a tiny pinch of cinnamon on top.
- 5 Drink immediately while it's really cold.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Door of the fridge is the warmest part. Back of the bottom shelf is the coldest. Milk lives at the back.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Iced:** add 2 ice cubes. **Chocolate:** stir in 1 tbsp cocoa + 1 tsp honey. **Vanilla:** 2 drops vanilla extract + ½ tsp sugar.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

★ PART FOUR ★



THE ROYAL DINNER

Served from 17:00 · free for all





CASTLE TOMATO

Creamy tomato soup · basil · crouton



FREE

25 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 tbsp butter
- ◆ 1 small onion, chopped
- ◆ 2 garlic cloves, sliced
- ◆ 1 tin chopped tomatoes (400g)
- ◆ 300ml vegetable stock
- ◆ 1 tsp sugar
- ◆ ½ tsp dried oregano
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ 3 tbsp crème fraîche (won't split on reheating!)
- ◆ A few basil leaves
- ◆ 2 slices bread for croutons
- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil

- 1** Heat oven to 200°C. Cube the bread, toss with oil and a pinch of salt. Bake 8 min for croutons.
- 2** Meanwhile, melt butter in a pot. Soften onion 5 min on medium-low.
- 3** Add garlic. Stir 1 min — don't let it brown.
- 4** Tip in tomatoes, stock, sugar, oregano, salt, and pepper.
- 5** Simmer 12 minutes — gentle bubble, not full boil.
- 6** Off heat. Blitz with a stick blender until totally smooth.
- 7** **Stir in crème fraîche** off the heat. (Cream splits. Crème fraîche doesn't — chef secret.)
- 8** Pour into bowls. Top with basil and croutons.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Crème fraîche won't split when the soup gets reheated. Regular cream curdles. Pro kitchens use crème fraîche.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** add a pinch of chilli flakes.
Roasted Tomato: roast 6 fresh tomatoes at 200°C for 30 min first.
Tomato & Basil Pesto: swirl in a tsp of pesto.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF bread** for croutons. Check the stock label.

FREE

40 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 2 bone-in chicken thighs (bones = flavor!)
- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ 1 onion, chopped
- ◆ 2 carrots, sliced
- ◆ 2 celery stalks, sliced
- ◆ 2 garlic cloves, sliced
- ◆ 1 liter chicken stock
- ◆ 1 bay leaf
- ◆ 1 sprig fresh thyme
- ◆ 100g small pasta or rice
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ A squeeze of lemon (the brightener!)
- ◆ Fresh parsley, chopped

- 1 Season chicken with salt and pepper.
- 2 Heat oil in a big pot. Brown chicken thighs 4 min per side — gives the soup deep flavor.
- 3 Add onion, carrots, celery, and garlic. Stir 5 min until softening.
- 4 Pour in the stock. Add bay leaf and thyme.
- 5 Simmer 20 minutes — gentle bubble.
- 6 Pull chicken out. Shred the meat off the bones with two forks. (Bones go in the bin.)
- 7 Drop the pasta into the soup and cook for 8 min.
- 8 Stir the shredded chicken back in. Off heat, squeeze in **lemon juice** — wakes the whole soup up.
- 9 Scatter parsley. Serve.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Bone-in chicken thighs make 10× better soup than boneless chicken breast. The bones release flavor.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Asian:** add ginger, soy, and noodles instead of pasta. **Creamy:** stir in 100ml cream at the end. **Spicy:** add chilli flakes.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **rice instead of pasta**, or **GF pasta**. Check stock label.

FREE

45 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 600g pumpkin or butternut squash, peeled, in chunks
- ◆ 1 onion, quartered
- ◆ 2 garlic cloves, in skins
- ◆ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ ¼ tsp pepper
- ◆ 1 tsp ground ginger (warm sweet kick)
- ◆ ½ tsp ground cumin
- ◆ 700ml vegetable stock
- ◆ 100ml double cream
- ◆ Pumpkin seeds, toasted

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 **Roast first — this is the secret.** Toss pumpkin, onion, and garlic with oil, salt, pepper, ginger, cumin.
- 3 Spread on a tray. Roast 30 min until soft and caramel edges.
- 4 (Roasting concentrates the sweetness. Boiling = bland soup.)
- 5 Squeeze garlic out of its skins.
- 6 Tip the vegetables into a pot. Pour over the stock.
- 7 Bring to a gentle simmer. Blitz with a stick blender until silky.
- 8 Stir in the cream.
- 9 Toast pumpkin seeds in a dry pan 2 min.
- 10 Pour soup into bowls. Drizzle a swirl of cream. Top with toasted seeds.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Roast, don't boil! The caramel edges from the oven are where the flavor lives.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Spicy:** add ½ tsp chilli flakes.
Coconut: swap cream for coconut milk. **Apple:** roast an apple along with the pumpkin.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF. Check the stock label.

FREE

2 HRS 30

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

- ◆ 600g beef chuck, in 3cm cubes
- ◆ 3 tbsp flour
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ 2 tbsp oil
- ◆ 1 onion, chopped
- ◆ 3 carrots, chunks
- ◆ 2 potatoes, chunks
- ◆ 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- ◆ 1 tbsp tomato paste
- ◆ 900ml beef stock (the no-wine version uses extra stock for body)
- ◆ 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce (the meaty-flavor secret)
- ◆ 1 bay leaf
- ◆ 1 sprig fresh thyme
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ 1 tsp brown sugar

- 1 Heat oven to 160°C.
- 2 Pat beef dry. Toss with seasoned flour.
- 3 Heat oil in a big oven-proof pot. **Brown the beef in batches** — don't crowd. Crowded meat steams instead of browning, and brown = flavor.
- 4 Set browned beef aside.
- 5 In the same pot, fry onion 5 min until golden.
- 6 Add garlic and tomato paste. Stir 1 min.
- 7 Pour in a splash of stock and scrape the brown bits from the bottom (this is the gold).
- 8 Add beef back, with carrots, potatoes, the rest of the stock, Worcestershire, bay leaf, thyme, salt, pepper, sugar.
- 9 Lid on. Into the oven for 2 hours.
- 10 Stew should be thick and beef should fall apart with a fork.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Browning in batches is non-negotiable. The flour-coated, browned bits at the bottom of the pot are 90% of the stew's flavor.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Mushroom:** add 250g mushrooms with the carrots. **Mash-topped:** top with mashed potato and grill — cottage pie style. **Spicy:** add chilli + cumin for a chili-con-carne vibe.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF flour**, check Worcestershire label (or use tamari + a dash of brown sugar).

D5

ROYAL PIZZA

Quick pizza · tomato · mozzarella · basil

1
SERVES

FREE

25 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 2 pizza bases (or 1 large) — shop-bought is fine
- ◆ 6 tbsp tomato passata
- ◆ 1 small garlic clove, grated
- ◆ 1 tsp olive oil
- ◆ ½ tsp dried oregano
- ◆ Pinch of sugar
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ 150g mozzarella ball, torn into chunks
- ◆ A few basil leaves
- ◆ Olive oil to drizzle

- 1 Heat oven to its **HIGHEST setting** (230–250°C) for at least 10 min. Slide a tray in to heat too.
- 2 (Pizza needs scorching heat or the base goes soggy. This is what makes it good.)
- 3 Mix passata, garlic, oil, oregano, sugar, and salt in a bowl.
- 4 Lay base on baking paper. Spread sauce, leaving a 2cm border.
- 5 Dot with mozzarella pieces (not too much — leaves space for it to bubble, not flood).
- 6 Slide onto the hot tray (with the paper).
- 7 Bake 7–9 min until crust is deep golden and cheese is bubbly with brown spots.
- 8 Off oven, scatter fresh basil, drizzle olive oil.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Pre-heating the tray is the home-pizza secret. The base crisps immediately like a pizza stone.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Pepperoni:** add pepperoni slices. **White:** swap tomato for ricotta + lemon zest + garlic oil. **Veggie:** add mushrooms, peppers, spinach.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF pizza base**. Most cheese and tomato sauce is naturally GF.

FREE

1 HR 30

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

MEAT SAUCE

- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ 1 onion, chopped
- ◆ 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- ◆ 500g beef mince
- ◆ 2 tbsp tomato paste
- ◆ 1 tin chopped tomatoes (400g)
- ◆ 100ml beef stock
- ◆ 1 tsp dried oregano
- ◆ 1 tsp brown sugar
- ◆ Salt & pepper

WHITE SAUCE

- ◆ 40g butter
- ◆ 40g flour
- ◆ 500ml whole milk
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ Pinch of nutmeg (the lasagna secret!)
- ◆ 60g grated parmesan

TO BUILD

- ◆ 10 lasagna sheets
- ◆ 150g grated mozzarella

- 1 MEAT SAUCE:** Heat oil in a big pan. Soften onion 5 min. Add garlic 1 min. Add mince, brown well 8 min (crumble with a wooden spoon).
- 2** Stir in tomato paste 1 min. Add tomatoes, stock, oregano, sugar, salt, pepper.
- 3** Simmer 25 min — should be THICK, not watery (watery = soggy lasagna).
- 4 WHITE SAUCE:** Melt butter in a pan. Stir in flour, cook 1 min.
- 5** Whisk in milk a splash at a time — keeps it smooth.
- 6** Simmer, whisking, 5 min until thick. Stir in salt, nutmeg, and parmesan.
- 7 BUILD:** Heat oven to 180°C. In a big dish:
- 8** Meat sauce → pasta sheets → white sauce → meat → pasta → white → meat → pasta → white → mozzarella on top.
- 9** Bake 35 min until golden and bubbling. **Rest 10 min before serving** — otherwise it slides apart.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Nutmeg in the white sauce is THE classic Italian secret. And resting the lasagna 10 min lets it firm up so it cuts into neat squares.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Veggie:** swap mince for 400g mushrooms + 1 tin lentils. **Spinach:** stir 200g cooked spinach into the white sauce. **Spicy:** chilli flakes in the meat sauce.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF lasagna sheets** and **GF flour**.



ROYAL ROAST

Sunday roast chicken · lemon · thyme



FREE

1 HR 45

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 whole chicken (about 1.5kg)
- ◆ 1 lemon
- ◆ 4 sprigs fresh thyme
- ◆ 4 garlic cloves
- ◆ 60g butter, soft
- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ 1 tsp salt
- ◆ ½ tsp pepper
- ◆ ½ tsp smoked paprika
- ◆ Vegetables for the tray: 4 potatoes, 2 carrots, 1 onion (all in chunks)

- 1 Take chicken out the fridge 30 min before cooking — room-temp chicken cooks evenly.
- 2 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 3 **The secret move — butter UNDER the skin.** Slide your fingers gently under the breast skin to make pockets.
- 4 Push half the butter under the skin on each breast. Massage to spread.
- 5 Rub remaining butter all over the outside. Sprinkle salt, pepper, and paprika.
- 6 Stuff the cavity with lemon halves (squeeze first), thyme, and 2 garlic cloves.
- 7 Scatter the chopped vegetables and remaining garlic around the chicken in a roasting tray.
- 8 Drizzle veg with olive oil and salt.
- 9 Roast 1 hour 15 minutes. Baste with pan juices every 30 min.
- 10 Check: a thermometer should read 75°C in the thigh. Or pierce the thigh — juices run clear.
- 11 **Rest 15 min before carving** — non-negotiable. Otherwise juice runs all over the board.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Butter under the skin is the difference between a dry roast chicken and a juicy one. Every chef does this. Most home cooks don't know.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Garlic:** 20 garlic cloves in the tray. **Spicy:** rub with harissa. **Maple:** brush with maple syrup in the last 15 min.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF. Make GF gravy from the pan drippings with GF flour.

FREE

30 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 200g macaroni
- ♦ 30g butter
- ♦ 30g flour
- ♦ 450ml whole milk (less = creamier – don't overflow)
- ♦ ½ tsp mustard powder (THE secret – wakes up cheese)
- ♦ Pinch of nutmeg
- ♦ Salt & pepper
- ♦ 100g grated cheddar (strong, mature)
- ♦ 50g grated gruyère
- ♦ 30g grated parmesan
- ♦ 30g breadcrumbs
- ♦ 1 tbsp melted butter

- 1 Cook the pasta to ONE MINUTE LESS than the packet says – it cooks more in the oven.
- 2 Drain. Save 60ml of the pasta water.
- 3 Meanwhile, in another pan, melt butter. Whisk in flour. Cook 1 min.
- 4 Whisk in milk a splash at a time. Whisk constantly until thick and smooth – 5 min.
- 5 **Off the heat, whisk in mustard powder, nutmeg, salt, pepper.** Then add cheddar and gruyère. Stir until melted.
- 6 Stir the pasta into the cheese sauce. If thick, add the pasta water 1 tbsp at a time.
- 7 Tip into a baking dish. Top with parmesan and breadcrumbs mixed with melted butter.
- 8 Grill 5 min until golden and bubbly.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Mustard powder is the chef trick that makes the cheese taste CHEESIER. Sounds weird, just trust it.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Bacon:** stir crispy bacon bits into the cheese sauce. **Truffle:** drizzle truffle oil on top. **Veggie:** stir in roasted broccoli.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF pasta**, **GF flour**, and **GF breadcrumbs**.

FREE

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 baguette or ciabatta
- ◆ 60g butter, soft
- ◆ 3 garlic cloves, GRATED
- ◆ 1 tbsp olive oil
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ 2 tbsp finely chopped parsley
- ◆ 2 tbsp grated parmesan (optional)

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 **Grate the garlic — don't chop.** Grated garlic spreads evenly through the butter. Chopped leaves you with garlic chunks that burn.
- 3 In a bowl, mix soft butter, grated garlic, olive oil, salt, and parsley.
- 4 Slice the bread diagonally, but NOT all the way through (keep it joined at the bottom).
- 5 Spread the garlic butter generously between each slice.
- 6 If using, sprinkle parmesan on top.
- 7 Wrap loosely in foil. Bake 10 min wrapped, then open the foil and bake 4 more min for crispy edges.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Grated garlic = even flavor throughout. Chopped garlic = burnt bitter bits. This is the only way.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Cheesy:** sprinkle mozzarella over the top in the last 4 min. **Spicy:** add chilli flakes. **Herb:** mix in rosemary and thyme.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF baguette**. Butter and garlic are GF.



ROYAL SALAD

Mixed leaves · tomato · cucumber · vinaigrette



FREE

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 120g mixed salad leaves
- ♦ 12 cherry tomatoes, halved
- ♦ ½ cucumber, sliced
- ♦ ¼ red onion, very thin slices
- ♦ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ♦ 1 tbsp red wine vinegar
- ♦ ½ tsp Dijon mustard
- ♦ ½ tsp honey
- ♦ Salt & pepper

- 1 **SOAK the onion slices in cold water 5 min** — same trick as Knight's Garden. Sweet, not sharp.
- 2 Wash and DRY the leaves really well.
- 3 Shake the dressing in a jar: oil + vinegar + mustard + honey + salt + pepper.
- 4 In a salad bowl: leaves + tomatoes + cucumber + drained onion.
- 5 Dress JUST BEFORE SERVING. Toss with hands gently.
- 6 Serve in a wide bowl.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Wet leaves = watered-down dressing. Dry them carefully with a tea towel or salad spinner.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Greek:** add feta and olives. **Italian:** add mozzarella and basil. **Fruity:** add apple or pear slices.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.



STEAMED GREENS

Broccoli · beans · lemon · butter



FREE

10 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 200g broccoli florets
- ◆ 150g green beans, trimmed
- ◆ 1 tbsp butter
- ◆ ½ tsp salt
- ◆ Zest of ½ lemon
- ◆ Pinch of chilli flakes (optional)
- ◆ 1 tbsp toasted flaked almonds

- 1 Bring a pan of salted water to the boil.
- 2 Drop in the green beans. After 1 min, add the broccoli.
- 3 Boil 3 more min — should still be bright green and crunchy.
- 4 Drain. **Tip into ice water** immediately to stop the cooking.
- 5 Drain again. Tip into a warm pan with butter, salt, lemon zest, and chilli (if using).
- 6 Toss to coat. Plate. Sprinkle toasted almonds.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Ice water shock is the trick. Without it, the vegetables turn army-green and limp.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Garlic:** grate a garlic clove into the butter. **Parmesan:** sprinkle parmesan. **Asian:** butter → soy + sesame oil + seeds.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.

FREE

15 MIN + chill EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 6 digestive biscuits
- ◆ 30g butter, melted
- ◆ 300g full-fat cream cheese
- ◆ 50g icing sugar
- ◆ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ◆ 60ml double cream
- ◆ Mixed berries
- ◆ Mint leaves

- 1 Crush biscuits in a bag with a rolling pin. Mix with melted butter.
- 2 Press into the bottom of 2 jars or small bowls.
- 3 Whisk cream cheese, icing sugar, and vanilla until smooth.
- 4 Whisk in the cream until thick and holds its shape.
- 5 Spoon onto the biscuit base in both jars.
- 6 **Chill at least 1 hour** (overnight is even better — the texture firms up).
- 7 Top with berries and mint right before serving.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Make these the night before. The base softens just enough to be sliced clean with a spoon.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Lemon:** add zest of ½ lemon.
Chocolate: chocolate biscuits + 1 tbsp cocoa. **Caramel:** drizzle caramel sauce.

GLUTEN-FREE Use **GF digestive biscuits**.

FREE

5 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 4 scoops vanilla ice cream
- ◆ 2 espresso shots (or strong coffee)
- ◆ 2 tbsp chocolate sauce
- ◆ 2 tbsp toasted hazelnuts
- ◆ Whipped cream
- ◆ 2 wafer biscuits (optional)

- 1 **AFFOGATO VERSION (the elegant dinner option):**
- 2 Toast hazelnuts 2 min in a dry pan.
- 3 Make 2 espresso shots (or 2 small cups of very strong coffee).
- 4 Put 2 scoops of ice cream in 2 small glasses or cups.
- 5 Pour the HOT espresso over the ice cream right at the table.
- 6 Top with whipped cream, chocolate drizzle, and toasted hazelnuts.
- 7 Eat fast with a spoon — hot melting ice cream is the magic.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Affogato (Italian for "drowned") is the ultimate dinner dessert. Hot espresso on cold ice cream is restaurant-level done in 3 minutes.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Boozy (adults):** add 1 tsp Amaretto or Baileys. **Tea:** swap espresso for strong Earl Grey. **Mocha:** add 1 tsp cocoa to the coffee.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF. Skip the wafer or use a GF biscuit.

FREE

35 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ◆ 100g dark chocolate (70%), chopped
- ◆ 100g butter
- ◆ 120g sugar
- ◆ 30g brown sugar (the chewy-edge secret)
- ◆ 2 eggs
- ◆ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ◆ ½ tsp instant espresso powder (THE chef trick!)
- ◆ 60g plain flour
- ◆ 15g cocoa powder
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ 50g chocolate chips
- ◆ Vanilla ice cream to serve

- 1 Heat oven to 180°C. Line a small (20cm) baking tin with paper.
- 2 Melt chocolate and butter together in a heat-proof bowl over a pan of simmering water. Stir until smooth.
- 3 Take off heat. Whisk in both sugars.
- 4 Add eggs ONE AT A TIME, whisking after each one — this is what makes the shiny top.
- 5 Stir in vanilla and **espresso powder**. (You won't taste coffee — it just makes chocolate taste MORE chocolatey.)
- 6 Sift flour, cocoa, and salt over. Fold gently with a spatula. Don't overmix.
- 7 Stir in chocolate chips. Pour into the tin.
- 8 Bake 20-22 min. Edges firm, middle slightly wobbly — they'll set as they cool.
- 9 Cool 10 min. Cut into squares. Serve warm with a scoop of vanilla ice cream on top.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Espresso powder + brown sugar are the two secrets that turn a basic brownie into a top-tier brownie. Tiny amounts, huge difference.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Salted Caramel:** swirl caramel sauce on top before baking + sea salt flakes. **Nutty:** stir in chopped walnuts. **Mint:** add 2 drops peppermint extract.

GLUTEN-FREE Swap flour for **GF flour blend**. Same fudgy result.

★ PART FIVE ★



THE LEGENDARY SPECIALS

Rare dishes · always ask the chef first





THE WHOLE CASTLE

Triple patty · three cheeses · bacon battlements · onion-ring portcullis



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

9

COINS

30 MIN

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

- ◆ 225g beef mince (3 patties)
- ◆ 1 big brioche bun
- ◆ 1 slice cheddar
- ◆ 1 slice Swiss cheese
- ◆ 1 slice pepper jack
- ◆ 4 strips streaky bacon
- ◆ 2 onion rings (recipe #8)
- ◆ A few pickle slices
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ 1 tsp oil
- ◆ Royal Sauce (recipe #0)

- 1 **First — ask the chef if the kitchen has a big bun and three cheeses ready.** No big bun, no Whole Castle.
- 2 Make the royal sauce and the onion rings (recipe #8) first — get them done before the patties.
- 3 Form 3 thin patties (75g each). Dimple each with your thumb. Salt and pepper both sides.
- 4 Cook the bacon in a dry pan until crispy. Set aside, keep the bacon fat in the pan.
- 5 Cook the patties in the bacon fat, 2 min per side. Lay a different cheese on each in the last 30 seconds. Cover so they melt.
- 6 Toast the big bun in the pan.
- 7 Build tall: bun → sauce → cheddar patty → bacon → Swiss patty → bacon → pepper jack patty → pickles → onion rings on top (the portcullis) → sauce → top bun.
- 8 Push a long skewer through the middle or it will fall over. Serve with a knife.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Three THIN patties stack better than three thick ones — and they still cook fast. A skewer through the middle holds the whole castle together.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Two Towers: just two patties if three is too much. **Veggie Castle:** use 3 veggie patties (recipe H1). **Spicy Keep:** add jalapeños between the layers.

GLUTEN-FREE

Use a **GF bun** and **GF onion rings** (recipe #8, GF version). Beef, bacon, cheese are all GF.



DRAGON-FIRE BURGER

Beef patty · pepper jack · jalapeño · hot honey



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

6

COINS

20 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 150g beef mince
- ◆ 1 brioche bun
- ◆ 1 slice pepper jack cheese
- ◆ 2 tbsp honey
- ◆ ¼ tsp chilli flakes (for the hot honey)
- ◆ A few jalapeño slices
- ◆ 1 tbsp mayonnaise
- ◆ 1 tsp hot sauce
- ◆ Salt & pepper
- ◆ 1 tsp oil

- 1 **First — ask the chef if there is hot honey and pepper jack in stock.** No fire, no Dragon-Fire Burger.
- 2 Make the hot honey: gently warm the honey with the chilli flakes in a small pan for 1 min. Let it sit — it gets hotter as it cools.
- 3 Mix the mayo and hot sauce for the spread.
- 4 Form 1 patty. Dimple it. Salt and pepper both sides.
- 5 Heat oil in a pan on medium-high. Cook the patty 3 min per side.
- 6 Lay the pepper jack on top in the last 30 seconds. Cover so it melts.
- 7 Toast the bun in the pan.
- 8 Build: bun → spicy mayo → patty → jalapeños → a big drizzle of hot honey → top bun.
- 9 Keep a glass of milk close. Milk beats spice, water does not.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Hot honey is the chef trick — sweet and spicy together is what makes this legendary. The honey gets hotter as it cools, so taste it before you drizzle.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Baby Dragon:** skip the jalapeños, light drizzle of honey. **Inferno:** double the chilli flakes and hot sauce. **Smoky Dragon:** add 2 strips of crispy bacon.

GLUTEN-FREE Use a **GF bun**. Check the hot sauce label. Honey and pepper jack are GF.



THE ROUND TABLE

Twelve nuggets · three dips · a moat of fries



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

7

COINS

40 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ Crown Nuggets x12 (recipe #6, double batch)
- ♦ Drawbridge Fries (recipe #5, double batch)
- ♦ Royal Sauce (recipe #0)
- ♦ 3 tbsp BBQ sauce
- ♦ 3 tbsp honey-mustard (2 tbsp honey + 1 tbsp mustard)
- ♦ A few chopped chives to garnish

- 1 **First — ask the chef if there is enough chicken for twelve nuggets.** A Round Table needs all twelve seats filled.
- 2 Make a double batch of Crown Nuggets (recipe #6) — you need 12.
- 3 Make a double batch of Drawbridge Fries (recipe #5).
- 4 Make the three dips: royal sauce in one bowl, BBQ in another, honey-mustard in the third (just stir honey and mustard together).
- 5 Find the biggest round plate or board in the kitchen.
- 6 Pile the fries in a ring around the edge — this is the moat.
- 7 Arrange the 12 nuggets in a circle inside the moat — the knights at the table.
- 8 Put the 3 dip bowls in the very middle.
- 9 Scatter chives over everything. Carry it to the table with two hands.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Timing is everything — start the fries first (they take longest), then the nuggets, so both are hot at the same moment.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Veggie Table: swap nuggets for breaded halloumi. **Spicy Table:** add a fourth dip — sriracha mayo. **Loaded Moat:** use Loaded Castle Fries (recipe #9).

GLUTEN-FREE

Use **GF nuggets** (recipe #6, GF version). Fries are naturally GF. Check the BBQ sauce label.



EXCALIBUR DOG

Foot-long hot dog · melted cheese · crispy onions



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

5

COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 1 foot-long hot dog sausage
- ♦ 1 foot-long hot dog bun
- ♦ 1 tsp butter
- ♦ 40g grated cheddar
- ♦ A big handful of crispy fried onions
- ♦ American mustard
- ♦ Ketchup

- 1** First — ask the chef if a foot-long sausage and bun are in stock. A short dog is not Excalibur.
- 2** Boil water in a long pan. Drop the sausage in. Turn the heat OFF. Let it sit 6 minutes — gentle heat, no splits.
- 3** Butter the inside of the bun. Toast it in a dry hot pan, butter-side down, 30 seconds.
- 4** Pull the sausage out, pat dry, lay it in the bun.
- 5** Scatter the grated cheddar along the hot sausage — the heat melts it.
- 6** If it needs more melt, pop it under a hot grill for 1 minute.
- 7** Zigzag mustard and ketchup over the top.
- 8** Finish with a long line of crispy onions — the legendary crunch.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Off-heat poaching keeps the long sausage juicy and stops it splitting. Crispy onions go on LAST so they stay crunchy.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Chili Excalibur: top with warm chili.
Pizza Dog: mozzarella and a spoon of pizza sauce.
Royal Dog: add pickles and a drizzle of royal sauce.

GLUTEN-FREE

Use a **GF foot-long bun**. Check the sausage and crispy onion labels.



STAINED-GLASS SHAKE

Five-layer milkshake · strawberry, vanilla, chocolate, caramel, mystery



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

4

COINS

20 MIN

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

- ◆ 1 tall clear glass

THE LAYERS (1 SCOOP ICE CREAM + TINY SPLASH OF MILK, EACH)

- ◆ Strawberry ice cream (pink)
- ◆ Vanilla ice cream (cream)
- ◆ Chocolate ice cream (brown)
- ◆ Caramel sauce + vanilla (gold)
- ◆ Mystery: blueberry ice cream (purple)

TO FINISH

- ◆ Whipped cream
- ◆ Sprinkles

- 1 First — ask the chef which five flavors are in stock.** The mystery layer changes with whatever the kitchen has.
- 2** This is a layering challenge — blend each layer ONE AT A TIME and keep them thick so they don't mix.
- 3** Blend the strawberry scoop with a tiny splash of milk until thick. Spoon it gently into the bottom of the glass.
- 4** Rinse the blender. Blend the vanilla layer thick. Spoon it **slowly over the back of a spoon** so it sits on top, not mixing.
- 5** Repeat with the chocolate layer. Spoon gently.
- 6** Repeat with the caramel layer (blend caramel sauce into a vanilla scoop).
- 7** Repeat with the mystery purple layer on top.
- 8** Crown with whipped cream and sprinkles. Hold it up to the light — five colors, like a castle window.

★ **ROYAL TIP** ★ Pour each layer SLOWLY over the back of a spoon — that spreads it gently so the colours stay separate instead of swirling into mud.

★ **MIX IT UP** ★ **Three-Glass Window:** just three layers if five is tricky. **Sour Window:** use sorbet layers. **Choc Window:** five shades of chocolate.

GLUTEN-FREE Check every ice cream label and the caramel sauce. Most are GF.



THE CHEF'S SECRET

He won't tell us what it is · he just smiles



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

5

COINS

?? MIN

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

- ◆ Whatever is freshest in the kitchen today
- ◆ 1 thing you have never cooked before
- ◆ A pinch of courage
- ◆ Salt & pepper (always)
- ◆ A tiny pinch of salt on the sweet bits
- ◆ One idea of your own

- 1 **First — and this one matters most — ask the chef what the secret is today.** It changes every single day.
- 2 The Chef's Secret is not really a recipe. It is a way of cooking.
- 3 Look in the fridge. Pick the ingredient that looks the best today — the freshest, the ripest.
- 4 Pick one cooking trick from anywhere in this book — the thumb dimple, the ice-water shock, toasting the nuts.
- 5 Taste as you go. Season a little, taste, season again. This is the real secret.
- 6 Plate it like you are proud of it. Wipe the edge of the plate clean.
- 7 Give it a name. Write the name down. Now it is YOUR secret.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

The chef's real secret is this: taste your food while you cook it. Salt, taste, adjust. That is the whole trick. He just smiles because it is so simple.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Every day: a different secret. **Write it down:** keep a notebook of your best ones. **Share it:** cook your secret for someone and watch their face.

GLUTEN-FREE

The secret can always be made gluten-free — just choose GF ingredients. The chef does not mind.



GOLDEN HOUR FRIES

Hand-cut fries · parmesan · herbs · cut at sunset, allegedly



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

3

COINS

35 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 3 large potatoes (Maris Piper or Russet)
- ♦ 2 tbsp olive oil
- ♦ ½ tsp salt
- ♦ 30g finely grated parmesan
- ♦ 1 tbsp finely chopped parsley
- ♦ ½ tsp dried oregano
- ♦ 1 small garlic clove, grated
- ♦ Black pepper

- 1** **First — ask the chef if good frying potatoes are in stock.** Golden Hour Fries need the right potato.
- 2** Cut the potatoes by hand into thin, even fries — hand-cut is part of the legend.
- 3** **Soak in cold water 15 minutes** to wash off the starch. Then dry them VERY well.
- 4** Toss with oil and salt. Spread on a tray in a single layer, not touching.
- 5** Bake at 220°C for 20 min. Flip. Bake 10 more min until deep golden — sunset color.
- 6** Mix the parmesan, parsley, oregano, grated garlic, and pepper in a big bowl.
- 7** Tip the hot fries straight into the bowl. Toss fast so the cheese melts onto them.
- 8** Serve immediately, while they still glow.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Toss the fries in the cheese-herb mix while they are still HOT from the oven — the heat melts the parmesan so it sticks to every fry.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Truffle Hour: add a tiny drizzle of truffle oil. **Spicy Sunset:** add chilli flakes. **Loaded Hour:** add crispy bacon bits.

GLUTEN-FREE

Naturally GF — potatoes, cheese, and herbs. No swaps needed.



THE DROUGHT-BREAKER

A bucket of lemonade · genuinely a bucket



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

4

COINS

15 MIN

EASY

YOU NEED

- ♦ 6 lemons (juice = about 240ml)
- ♦ 9 tbsp sugar
- ♦ 9 tbsp hot water
- ♦ 1.5 liters cold sparkling water
- ♦ 2 oranges, sliced
- ♦ 12 strawberries, halved
- ♦ A big handful of mint leaves
- ♦ Lots of ice
- ♦ 1 clean bucket or huge jug

- 1 **First — ask the chef if there are enough lemons in stock.** A Drought-Breaker needs six.
- 2 Make the syrup: stir the sugar into the HOT water until it fully dissolves.
- 3 Squeeze all 6 lemons. Stir the juice into the syrup.
- 4 Find the bucket. Wash it really well. (Or use the biggest jug in the kitchen.)
- 5 Drop in the orange slices, strawberries, and mint leaves.
- 6 **Gently squish the mint** against the side with a spoon to release the smell.
- 7 Tip in lots of ice. Pour over the lemon syrup.
- 8 Top up with all the cold sparkling water. Stir once.
- 9 Serve with a ladle and lots of cups. Share it across the whole kingdom.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Always dissolve sugar in HOT water first — cold water leaves gritty sugar at the bottom. Squish the mint, never chop it, or it goes bitter.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Berry Flood: add raspberries and blackberries. **Cloudy Bucket:** add a splash of cloudy apple juice. **Ginger Storm:** top with ginger ale instead of sparkling water.

GLUTEN-FREE Naturally GF.



THE CROWN JEWEL

Warm chocolate cake · molten center · gold-dusted · one candied cherry



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

5

COINS

25 MIN

CHALLENGE

YOU NEED

- ◆ 100g dark chocolate (70%), chopped
- ◆ 100g butter, plus extra for the moulds
- ◆ 2 eggs
- ◆ 2 egg yolks
- ◆ 60g sugar
- ◆ 40g plain flour
- ◆ Pinch of salt
- ◆ 1 tbsp cocoa powder for dusting the moulds
- ◆ Edible gold dust (a little)
- ◆ 2 candied cherries
- ◆ Vanilla ice cream to serve

- 1 First — ask the chef if there are ramekins free and chocolate in stock.** The Crown Jewel needs both.
- 2** Heat oven to 200°C. Butter 2 ramekins really well, then dust the inside with cocoa — this stops sticking.
- 3** Melt the chocolate and butter together in a bowl over a pan of simmering water. Stir smooth. Let it cool slightly.
- 4** In another bowl, whisk the eggs, egg yolks, and sugar until pale and a bit fluffy.
- 5** Pour the melted chocolate into the egg mix. Fold gently.
- 6** Sift in the flour and salt. Fold JUST until combined — do not overmix.
- 7** Divide between the ramekins. **Bake exactly 12 minutes** — set a timer. The edge sets, the middle stays molten.
- 8** Wait 1 minute. Run a knife around the edge, turn out onto a plate.
- 9** Dust with a tiny shimmer of gold. One candied cherry on top. A scoop of ice cream beside. Serve at once — the jewel must be warm.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

The 12-minute timer is everything. One minute too long and the molten middle sets solid. Set a timer and trust it.

★ MIX IT UP ★

White Jewel: use white chocolate.
Salted Jewel: sea salt flakes on top.
Surprise Jewel: push a square of chocolate into the middle before baking.

GLUTEN-FREE

Swap the flour for **GF flour blend**. Same molten result.

**ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?**

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

4

COINS

20 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ♦ 1 waffle (shop-bought is fine, or homemade)
- ♦ 2 scoops vanilla ice cream
- ♦ 2 tbsp chocolate sauce
- ♦ 2 tbsp strawberry sauce
- ♦ 2 tbsp caramel sauce
- ♦ Whipped cream
- ♦ 1 tbsp sprinkles
- ♦ 1 tbsp toasted chopped nuts
- ♦ A candied cherry

- 1** First — ask the chef if there are waffles and all three sauces in stock. No three sauces, no show.
- 2** Toast the waffle until crisp and warm — a warm waffle against cold ice cream is the magic.
- 3** Toast the chopped nuts in a dry pan for 1-2 minutes.
- 4** Lay the warm waffle on the best plate in the kitchen.
- 5** Put the 2 scoops of ice cream in the middle of the waffle.
- 6** Now the show: drizzle all THREE sauces in fast zigzags across the whole plate — chocolate, then strawberry, then caramel.
- 7** Pile whipped cream on top.
- 8** Shower with sprinkles and toasted nuts. Cherry on the very top.
- 9** Carry it to the table fast — the wizard's show is the warm waffle melting the cold ice cream.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

The "show" is just warm waffle meeting cold ice cream — so toast the waffle last, and run it to the table. Speed is the magic trick.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Berry Wizard: pile on fresh berries.
Choc Wizard: use three kinds of chocolate sauce. **Banana Wizard:** add sliced banana under the ice cream.

GLUTEN-FREE

Use a **GF waffle**. Check all three sauce labels.



THE KINGDOM SUNDAE

Built tall · built proud · built to fall over slightly · two spoons



ASK THE CHEF FIRST — IS IT IN STOCK?

Legendary specials are not always ready. Check with the kitchen before you start cooking.

5

COINS

10 MIN

MEDIUM

YOU NEED

- ◆ 4 scoops ice cream (mix of vanilla, chocolate, strawberry)
- ◆ 1 brownie, broken into chunks (recipe D14)
- ◆ 2 tbsp chocolate sauce
- ◆ 2 tbsp caramel sauce
- ◆ Whipped cream
- ◆ 1 tbsp toasted nuts
- ◆ 1 tbsp sprinkles
- ◆ 2 wafer biscuits
- ◆ 2 candied cherries
- ◆ The tallest glass in the kitchen

- 1 **First — ask the chef for the tallest glass and check the ice cream stock.** A Kingdom Sundae needs height.
- 2 Toast the nuts in a dry pan for 2 minutes.
- 3 Find the tallest glass or sundae bowl in the kitchen.
- 4 Layer from the bottom: 1 scoop ice cream → brownie chunks → drizzle of chocolate sauce.
- 5 Next layer: 1 scoop → caramel drizzle → a few nuts.
- 6 Keep going up: scoop → sauce → scoop → sauce. Build it as TALL as you dare.
- 7 Crown the very top with a big swirl of whipped cream.
- 8 Push the 2 wafers in like flags. Scatter sprinkles and nuts. A cherry on top.
- 9 It should lean just slightly — that is how you know it is tall enough. Two spoons. Share it.

★ ROYAL TIP ★

Alternate hard scoops with soft sauce and brownie — that locks the layers together so your tower leans but does not topple.

★ MIX IT UP ★

Banana Kingdom: line the glass with banana slices. **Cookie Kingdom:** use crumbled cookies instead of brownie. **Berry Kingdom:** layer in fresh berries.

GLUTEN-FREE

Use a **GF brownie** (recipe D14, GF version) and **GF wafers**. Check the sauce labels.

★ THE END ★

A NOTE FROM THE ROYAL CHEF

If you've made it to the end of this book – congratulations, royal cook. You now hold the secrets of the castle kitchen.

Don't be afraid to mess up. Burnt toast, lumpy sauce, exploded mozzarella – every chef has been there. The best cooks are the ones who try things, taste, and try again.

Cook for the people you love. Eat with people you love. And always toast the bun.

— Chef Peter



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